Historical Temples and Monuments of Karnataka: Complete Study Notes (KPSC / KAS / KEA / PSI / FDA)

> Compiled November 2026. Arranged **dynasty by dynasty**, with the architectural style, date, patron, political background and key monument facts for each temple. Section 14 covers **temples and heritage sites in the news, May–November 2026**, with newspaper sources.
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> **Note on scope:** the Muzrai (Endowment) Department alone manages about 34,000–39,000 temples, so no list can name every temple in Karnataka. These notes cover the **historically important, ASI/State-protected, UNESCO-listed and major pilgrimage temples** that competitive exams ask about.

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1. Architectural styles of Karnataka at a glance

Style / phase	Period	Key features	Best examples
Kadamba	4th–6th c	Earliest Karnataka style; stepped pyramidal *shikhara* topped by a *kalasha* (the “Kadamba shikhara”, later reused by Hoysalas and Vijayanagara)	Madhukeshwara (Banavasi), Pranaveshwara (Talagunda)
Western Ganga	4th–10th c	Simple Dravida temples, Jain basadis, *manastambhas*, colossal monoliths	Gommateshwara (Shravanabelagola), Panchakuta Basadi (Kambadahalli)
Early (Badami) Chalukya	6th–8th c	“Laboratory/cradle of Indian temple architecture”; rock-cut caves, then structural temples in **both Nagara (north) and Dravida (south)** forms side by side; red sandstone	Badami caves, Aihole, Pattadakal, Mahakuta

Style / phase	Period	Key features	Best examples
Rashtrakuta	8th–10th c	Continued Dravida; rock-cut grandeur (Ellora Kailasa in Maharashtra); Jain patronage	Jain Narayana (Pattadakal), Navalinga (Kukkanur)
Kalyani (Western) Chalukya / "Gadag style"	10th–12th c	**Vesara** (hybrid) style; soapstone (chloritic schist); ornate lathe-turned pillars, stepped (staggered square) plans, decorated doorways, stepped wells (*kalyanis*)	Mahadeva (Itagi), Lakkundi, Trikuteshwara (Gadag), Doddabasappa (Dambal)
Hoysala	11th–14th c	Evolved Vesara; **stellate (star-shaped) plan** on a raised platform (*jagati*); soapstone; horizontal friezes (elephants, lions, horses, scrolls, epics); *madanikas*/*shilabalikas* (bracket figures); lathe-turned pillars; **sculptors signed their work** (Ruvari Mallitamma, Dasoja, Chavana, Kedaroja); *ekakuta*, *dvikuta*, *trikuta*, *chatushkuta*, *panchakuta* layouts	Belur, Halebidu, Somanathapura
Vijayanagara	14th–17th c	Dravida; granite; huge **rayagopuras**; *kalyana mantapas*; pillars with rearing horses and *yalis*; **musical pillars**; separate *Amman* (goddess) shrines; temple chariot streets and bazaars	Hampi (Virupaksha, Vittala, Hazara Rama), Vidyashankara (Sringeri)
Keladi / Ikkeri	16th–18th c	Blend of Hoysala, Vijayanagara and Kadamba features plus coastal elements	Aghoreshwara (Ikkeri), Rameshwara (Keladi)
Mysuru Wodeyar	17th–20th c	Tall Dravida gopuras; Indo-Saracenic palaces	Chamundeshwari gopura, palace temples
Coastal (Tulu Nadu / Kerala type)	Medieval to living	Sloping tiled or copper roofs, wooden elements, *bhuta* (spirit) shrines, laterite	Kukke Subramanya, Udupi, Kateel, Kollur
Indo-Islamic (Deccan)	14th–17th c	Domes, arches, minarets (Bahmani, Adil Shahi, Barid Shahi)	Gol Gumbaz, Ibrahim Rauza, Bidar Madrasa

Remember: Karnataka is the only Indian state where **Nagara, Dravida and Vesara** styles stand together. Pattadakal is the classic example, with Nagara and Dravida temples in one complex.

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2. UNESCO World Heritage and Tentative List sites

Site	Year inscribed	Notes
Group of Monuments at Hampi	1986	Vijayanagara capital; on the "in danger" list 1999–2006 (over bridge construction)
Group of Monuments at Pattadakal	1987	Chalukyan coronation town; Nagara and Dravida side by side
Western Ghats (natural, serial site with Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Maharashtra)	2012	Includes Kudremukh, Kali, Nagarahole, Talacauvery, Pushpagiri, Brahmagiri and others
Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas (Belur, Halebidu, Somanathapura)	**Sept 2023** (45th session, Riyadh)	India's **42nd** World Heritage Site; on the Tentative List since 2014

Tentative List / proposals - *Evolution of Temple Architecture – Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal* (Tentative List, 2015) - *Monuments and Forts of the Deccan Sultanate* (Bidar, Kalaburagi, Vijayapura) (Tentative List, 2014) - *Srirangapatna island town* (Tentative List) - **April 2026:** the State heritage department proposed **Shravanabelagola, Lakkundi and Hirebenakal** for UNESCO nomination (Deccan Herald, 10 Apr 2026). See Section 14.

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3. Kadambas of Banavasi (345–540 CE)

Political history: Founded by **Mayurasharma**, a Brahmin who rebelled against the Pallavas of Kanchi. Capital: **Banavasi** (Uttara Kannada). **Kakusthavarma** was the greatest ruler. The Kadambas were the **first native dynasty to use Kannada in administration**. The **Talagunda pillar inscription** (Sanskrit, composed by Kubja, of Shantivarma's time) narrates Mayurasharma's story. The **Halmidi inscription** (c. 450 CE, Hassan district) is the **oldest known Kannada inscription**. The dynasty was absorbed by the Badami Chalukyas. Later branches were the **Kadambas of Hangal and Goa**.

Temple	Place	Details
Madhukeshwara Temple	Banavasi, Uttara Kannada	Original Kadamba shrine to Shiva (Madhukeshwara), rebuilt and extended by later dynasties (Chalukya, Hoysala, Vijayanagara, Sonda). Features a carved **stone cot (*kallina manche*)** gifted by the Sonda rulers (17th c). Banavasi is also mentioned in Ashokan-era Buddhist texts (Vanavasi). The **Kadambotsava** festival is held here.
Pranaveshwara Temple	Talagunda, Shivamogga	Among the oldest temples in Karnataka; the **Talagunda pillar inscription** stands here
Kadamba shikhara	—	Stepped, pyramidal tower without decoration, ending in a *kalasha*; seen later at Doddagaddavalli (Hoysala) and Hampi

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4. Western Gangas, Banas and Nolambas (c. 350–1000 CE)

Political history: The Western Gangas ruled Gangavadi (south Karnataka) from **Kolar**, then **Talakad**. **Durvinita** was a scholar-king. **Shivamara**, **Rachamalla** and **Marasimha II** were strong patrons of **Jainism**. The dynasty ended when the **Cholas captured Talakad (c. 1004)**. Their minister **Chavundaraya** built the Gommateshwara statue. The **Banas** and **Nolambas** were feudatories in the Kolar–Tumakuru–Chitradurga belt.

Temple / monument	Place	Date / patron	Details
Gommateshwara (Bahubali)	Vindhyagiri hill, **Shravanabelagola**, Hassan	**c. 981–983 CE**; **Chavundaraya**, minister of Ganga king **Rachamalla IV**	**57 ft (≈17 m) monolith**, one of the largest free-standing monoliths in the world. **Mahamastakabhisheka** every 12 years: last in **2018** (88th), next due **2030**. Inscriptions in Kannada, Tamil and Marathi at its base, including one of the earliest Marathi inscriptions. Proposed for UNESCO (2026).
Chandragiri hill basadis	Shravanabelagola	8th–12th c	**Chavundaraya Basadi**; **Bhadrabahu cave**. Tradition says **Chandragupta Maurya** came here with Jain saint Bhadrabahu and died by *sallekhana*. Over 100 inscriptions.
Panchalinga temples and **Vaidyeshwara Temple**	**Talakadu**, Mysuru (Kaveri bank)	Ganga origins; Chola and Hoysala additions	Five Shiva shrines (Vaidyeshwara, Arkeshwara, Pataleshwara, Maruleshwara, Mallikarjuna). Talakad lies under **sand dunes**, linked to the "curse of Alamelamma" on the Wodeyars. The **Panchalinga Darshana** festival is held at irregular intervals (on a Kartika new moon with a special star combination).
Kirtinarayana Temple	Talakadu	**1117, Hoysala Vishnuvardhana**	Built to celebrate the defeat of the Cholas at Talakad (1116)
Panchakuta Basadi	**Kambadahalli**, Mandya	c. 10th c, Ganga	Five-shrine Jain temple in Dravida style; tall *manastambha* (Brahmadeva pillar)

Temple / monument	Place	Date / patron	Details
Nageshwara Temple	**Begur**, Bengaluru	Ganga, 9th–10th c	The **Begur inscription (c. 890 CE)** gives the **earliest known mention of "Bengaluru"** (records the "Bengaluru war")
Bhoga Nandishwara Temple	**Nandi village**, foot of Nandi Hills, Chikkaballapur	9th c (Bana queen **Ratnavali**); additions by Gangas, Cholas, Hoysalas and Vijayanagara	Twin shrines (Bhoga Nandishwara and Arunachaleshwara) plus Uma-Maheshwara with an ornate Vijayanagara *kalyana mantapa*; *Shringi tirtha* tank; ASI-protected
Kolaramma Temple	Kolar	Ganga origin, **Chola** rebuild (11th c)	Goddess temple with Chola inscriptions; scorpion deity (Chelamma) shrine
Ramalingeshwara group	**Avani**, Kolar	Nolamba/Chola, 10th c	Group of Shiva shrines; Avani is linked to Valmiki legend
Kalleshwara Temple	**Aralaguppe**, Tumakuru	Nolamba, 9th–10th c	Famous ceiling panel of dancing Shiva surrounded by *dikpalas*
Ranganatha Temple	**Srirangapatna**, Mandya	**894 CE** (Ganga, Tirumalaiah); expanded by Hoysalas, Vijayanagara and Wodeyars	"**Adi Ranga**", first of the three Ranganatha shrines on the Kaveri (Madhya Ranga at Shivanasamudra, Antya Ranga at Srirangam, Tamil Nadu)

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5. Badami Chalukyas (543–757 CE)

Political history: Founded by **Pulakeshin I**, who fortified **Vatapi (Badami)** and performed the Ashwamedha. **Mangalesha** finished the cave temples. **Pulakeshin II** (610–642) defeated **Harshavardhana on the Narmada** (c. 618–619), as recorded in the **Aihole inscription (634 CE)** composed by court poet **Ravikirti** in the Meguti temple. Pulakeshin II was later killed when the Pallava **Narasimhavarman I ("Vatapikonda")** captured Badami (642). **Vikramaditya I** recovered the kingdom. **Vikramaditya II** captured **Kanchi** three times. His queens **Lokamahadevi** and **Trailokyamahadevi** built the Virupaksha and Mallikarjuna temples at Pattadakal. **Kirtivarman II** was overthrown by the Rashtrakuta **Dantidurga** (753). Chinese pilgrim **Hiuen Tsang** visited Pulakeshin II's kingdom.

5A. Badami (Vatapi), Bagalkot district

Monument	Date	Details
Cave 1	6th c	**Shaiva**; **18-armed dancing Shiva (Nataraja)** showing 81 dance poses; Ardhanarishvara, Harihara
Cave 2	6th c	**Vaishnava**; Trivikrama and Varaha panels
Cave 3	**578 CE** (inscription of **Mangalesha**)	**Largest**, Vaishnava; Vishnu on Adishesha, Narasimha, Harihara, painted ceilings (traces of early paintings)
Cave 4	7th c	**Jain**; Bahubali, Parshvanatha, Mahavira
Upper and Lower Shivalaya, **Malegitti Shivalaya**	7th c	Structural Dravida temples on the rock outcrops; Malegitti is one of the finest early Dravida temples
Bhutanatha group	7th c and later	On the bank of **Agastya tirtha** lake
Jambulinga Temple	**699 CE**	Trikuta (three-shrine) temple, built by Vinayavati, mother of Vinayaditya
Banashankari Temple	Cholachagudda near Badami	Kuladevata of the Chalukyas; current structure rebuilt in the 18th c; **Banashankari jatre** in January

5B. Aihole, Bagalkot: “Cradle of Indian temple architecture”

About **125 temples** in groups (Kontigudi, Galaganatha, Ambigera, Tryambakeshwara, Ramalinga and others), and the first Chalukyan capital.

Temple	Date	Details
Lad Khan Temple	Once dated to the 5th c, now c. 7th c	Square flat-roofed hall resembling a village *panchayat* hall; named after a Muslim man who lived in it
Durga Temple	Late 7th–early 8th c	**Apsidal (*gajaprishta*, elephant-back) plan** modelled on Buddhist chaitya halls; name comes from *durg* (fort), **not** the goddess Durga; peristyle walkway
Huchimalligudi	7th c	Earliest example of an **antarala** (vestibule) between sanctum and hall
Ravanaphadi Cave	6th c	Shaiva rock-cut cave; dancing Shiva, Saptamatrikas
Meguti Jain Temple	**634 CE**	Holds the **Aihole inscription of Ravikirti** (Pulakeshin II’s victory over Harsha; mentions Kalidasa and Bharavi). **Oldest dated structural temple in Karnataka.**
Gaudaragudi, **Chakragudi**, **Kontigudi group**, **Hucchappayyagudi**	6th–8th c	Early experiments in roofing and towers

5C. Pattadakal, Bagalkot (UNESCO 1987)

“Pattada Kisuvolal”, the **coronation site** of the Chalukyas, on the Malaprabha river. It has 10 major temples: **four Nagara, four Dravida, one mixed (Papanatha) and one Jain**.

Temple	Style	Date / patron	Details
Virupaksha (Lokeshwara)	Dravida	**c. 740–745**, Queen **Lokamahadevi**	Commemorates **Vikramaditya II’s victory over the Pallavas of Kanchi**; modelled on the **Kailasanatha temple of Kanchi** and in turn inspired the **Kailasa temple at Ellora**. Largest and finest. **Sculptor: Gunda Anivaritachari.** Ramayana, Mahabharata and Panchatantra panels. Still a living temple.
Mallikarjuna (Trailokeshwara)	Dravida	c. 745, Queen **Trailokyamahadevi**	Smaller twin of Virupaksha
Sangameshwara (Vijayeshwara)	Dravida	**Vijayaditya** (696–733)	**Oldest** temple at Pattadakal
Papanatha	**Mixed Nagara + Dravida**	c. 680–740	Ramayana friezes
Galaganatha	Nagara (curvilinear *rekha-prasada*)	8th c	Sculpture of Shiva killing Andhakasura
Kashi Vishweshwara	Nagara	8th c	**Last** of the early Chalukyan temples here
Kadasiddheshwara, **Jambulingeshwara**	Nagara	7th c	Small early Nagara shrines
Chandrashekhara	Dravida (no tower)	8th c	Small
Jain Narayana Basadi	Dravida	**9th c, Rashtrakuta**	Two-storeyed Jain temple

5D. Mahakuta, Bagalkot

- **Mahakuteshwara group**: Shaiva temples around the **Vishnupushkarini** tank.
- **Mahakuta pillar inscription** of **Mangalesha** (c. 595–602 CE) records the conquests of Kirtivarman I.

*(The Chalukyan **Navabrahma temples at Alampur** are now in Telangana.)*

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6. Rashtrakutas (753–973 CE)

Political history: Founded by **Dantidurga**. Capital at **Manyakheta (Malkhed, Kalaburagi)**. **Krishna I** built the **Kailasa temple at Ellora** (Maharashtra). **Dhruva** and **Govinda III** raided north India (the "tripartite struggle" for Kannauj). **Amoghavarsha I** was a Jain-leaning patron, compared to Ashoka by historians, and author/patron of **Kavirajamarga** (earliest extant Kannada work on poetics, by Srivijaya). Arab traveller **Sulaiman** ranked him among the four great kings of the world. **Krishna III** defeated the Cholas at Takkolam (949). The dynasty was overthrown by **Tailapa II** (Kalyani Chalukya) in 973.

Temple	Place	Details
Navalinga Temple	**Kukkanur**, Koppal	9th c; group of **nine shrines** with lingas, Dravida style
Kalleshwara Temple	Kukkanur	Rashtrakuta to early Kalyani Chalukya transition
Jain Narayana	Pattadakal	See 5C
Neminatha Basadi	Malkhed (Manyakheta)	Jain centre in the Rashtrakuta capital
Sirval / Sannati area temples	Kalaburagi	Rashtrakuta-era shrines on the Bhima river

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7. Kalyani / Western Chalukyas (973–1189 CE)

Political history: Tailapa II revived Chalukya power. Capital at **Kalyani (Basavakalyan, Bidar)**. **Vikramaditya VI** (1076–1126) founded the **Chalukya-Vikrama era** (1076). His court had **Bilhana** (*Vikramankadevacharita*) and **Vijnaneshwara** (*Mitakshara*, the commentary on Hindu inheritance law). The empire declined after the **Kalachuri Bijjala** usurped power. The **Vachana / Sharana movement of Basavanna** (12th c) took place at Kalyani: **Anubhava Mantapa**, Bijjala's court. Patronage passed to Hoysalas, Seunas (Yadavas) and Kakatiyas. **Style:** Vesara; soapstone; dense decoration; known as the **"Gadag school"**, centred on Gadag, Dharwad, Haveri, Koppal and Ballari districts.

Temple	Place	Date / patron	Details
Mahadeva Temple	**Itagi**, Koppal	**1112 CE**, **Mahadeva**, army commander of Vikramaditya VI	Inscription calls it **"Devalaya Chakravarti" (Emperor among temples)**; superb lathe-turned pillars
Brahma Jinalaya	**Lakkundi**, Gadag	**1007 CE**, **Attimabbe** (*"Danachintamani"*), patron of poet Ponna	Large Jain basadi in early Kalyani Chalukya style
Kashivishweshwara, **Nanneshwara**, **Manikeshwara**, **Mallikarjuna**, **Kumbaragudi** temples	Lakkundi	11th–12th c	Lakkundi once had about **50 temples and 101 stepwells**; **Musukina Bhavi** (veiled stepwell); a **mint** in Hoysala and Chalukya times. **2026 excavation** (Section 14).

Temple	Place	Date / patron	Details
Trikuteshwara Temple	Gadag	11th c	Three lingas on one pedestal; Saraswati shrine with exquisite pillars
Veeranarayana Temple	Gadag	12th c (Hoysala Vishnuvardhana era additions)	**Kumaravyasa** composed *Gadugina Bharata* (Karnata Bharata Kathamanjari) here
Doddabasappa Temple	**Dambal**, Gadag	12th c	Unusual **24-pointed stellate plan**
Someshwara Temple and **Shankha Basadi**	**Lakshmeshwar**, Gadag	11th c	Shaiva and Jain temples together; the Shankha basadi has a sahasrakuta (1000-image) Jina
Amriteshwara Temple	**Annigeri**, Dharwad	**c. 1050**	Among the earliest large soapstone Chalukyan temples; Annigeri claims to be the birthplace of **Adikavi Pampa**
Chandramouleshwara Temple	**Unkal**, Hubballi	12th c	Has **four entrances**, one on each side
Siddheshwara Temple	Haveri	Late 11th c	Faces west; Uma-Maheshwara sculpture
Tarakeshwara Temple	**Hangal**, Haveri	12th c (Kadambas of Hangal, feudatories)	Huge domed ceiling with lotus
Mukteshwara Temple	**Chaudayyadanapura**, Haveri	11th–13th c	On the Tungabhadra; associated with Vachana poet Muktayakka and Ambigara Chaudayya
Kalleshwara Temple	**Bagali**, Vijayanagara district	10th–11th c	Erotic and Bhairava sculptures, about 30 inscriptions
Kedareshwara and **Tripurantakeshwara**	**Balligavi (Belagami)**, Shivamogga	c. 1060 (Kalyani Chalukya and Hoysala)	Balligavi was a **Kalamukha Shaiva** centre, "**Dakshina Kedara**"; near **Udutadi**, birthplace of **Akka Mahadevi**
Kadambeshwara Temple	Rattihalli, Haveri	12th c	Kadamba feudatory work
Mallikarjuna Temple	Kuruvatti, Vijayanagara district	11th c	Chalukyan carvings of Shiva-Parvati
Banashankari Temple	Amargol, Dharwad	12th c	Twin temple group
Sangameshwara and **Basavanna Aikya Mantapa**	**Kudalasangama**, Bagalkot	Chalukyan temple; aikya mantapa modern	Confluence of the Krishna and Malaprabha; **Basavanna's samadhi (aikya)**
Anubhava Mantapa (new)	**Basavakalyan**, Bidar	Under construction (2021 onward)	Modern ₹600+ crore memorial to Basavanna's 12th-century "parliament" (Section 14)

8. Hoysalas (c. 1006–1346 CE)

Political history: Hill chieftains from **Sosevur (Angadi, Chikkamagaluru)**. The emblem shows **Sala killing a tiger (lion)**. **Vinayaditya** and **Ereyanga** were Chalukyan feudatories. **Vishnuvardhana (Bittideva, c. 1108–1152)** defeated the **Cholas at Talakad (1116)** and was influenced by **Ramanujacharya** (Sri Vaishnavism); his queen **Shantala Devi** was a Jain and a celebrated dancer. Capital moved from **Belur** to **Dwarasamudra (Halebidu)**. **Veera Ballala II** declared independence

(c. 1187) and defeated the Seunas. **Narasimha III** ruled in the north while **Ramanatha** ruled the Tamil country (division of the kingdom). **Malik Kafur** sacked Dwarasamudra in **1311**. **Veera Ballala III** was killed fighting the Madurai Sultanate (1343). The Hoysala lands passed to **Vijayanagara**. About 1,500 temples were built; around **92–100 survive**.

The three UNESCO temples (2023)

Temple	Place	Date / patron	Key details
Chennakeshava Temple (Vijayanarayana)	**Belur**, Hassan (Yagachi river)	**1117**, **Vishnuvardhana**, to celebrate the **Talakad victory over the Cholas**	Took about **103 years** to finish (three generations). Star-shaped *jagati*; **42 madanikas** (bracket figures) including **Darpana Sundari** (lady with mirror). **Narasimha pillar** (once said to rotate). **Kappe Chennigaraya** shrine (built by Queen Shantala). **Rayagopura** added by **Vijayanagara**. Legend of sculptor **Jakanachari** and his son **Dakanachari**. **Living temple**; Belur rathotsava.
Hoysaleshwara Temple	**Halebidu (Dwarasamudra)**, Hassan	**c. 1121**, built by **Ketamalla**, an officer of Vishnuvardhana	**Twin shrines**: Hoysaleshwara (the king) and **Shantaleshwara** (Queen Shantala), each with a **Nandi mantapa**. Over 240 wall images; **frieze of 2,000 elephants**. Sculptor **Kedaroja**. Left **unfinished**; damaged in the **1311 (Malik Kafur)** and later raids. **Dorasamudra lake**. Halebidu also has the **Jain basadis** (Parshvanatha, Shantinatha, Adinatha; Parshvanatha basadi 1133 by **Boppa**, son of general Gangaraja) and the **Kedareshwara temple** (1219, Veera Ballala II). ASI museum.
Keshava Temple	**Somanathapura**, Mysuru (Kaveri bank)	**1268**, **Somanatha Dandanayaka**, general of **Narasimha III**	**Trikuta** (three shrines: Keshava, Janardhana, Venugopala); 16-pointed star plan; 64 cells in the cloister. **Best-preserved complete Hoysala temple.** Sculptor **Ruvari Mallitamma** signed many images. No longer worshipped (ASI monument).

Other important Hoysala temples

Temple	Place	Date / patron	Details
Lakshmidevi Temple	**Doddagaddavalli**, Hassan	**1113/1114**; merchant **Kullahana Rahuta** and wife Sahaja Devi	**Earliest major Hoysala temple**; *chatushkuta* (four shrines); Kadamba-style towers; **Kali** and **Betala** guardians
Lakshmi Narasimha Temple	**Nuggehalli**, Hassan	**1246**; **Bommanna Dandanayaka** (Vira Someshwara's reign)	Trikuta; sculptors Mallitamma and Baichoja; nearby **Sadashiva Temple**
Lakshmi Narasimha Temple	**Javagal**, Hassan	c. 1250	Trikuta
Lakshmi Narasimha Temple	**Haranhalli**, Hassan	1235	Also Someshwara temple
Lakshminarayana Temple	**Hosaholalu**, Mandya	c. 1250 (Narasimha III)	Trikuta, close copy of Somanathapura
Amruteshwara Temple	**Amruthapura**, Chikkamagaluru	**1196**; **Amitayya**, general of **Veera Ballala II**	Inscription composed by poet **Janna**; 140 Ramayana and Mahabharata panels; sculptor **Ruvari Mallitamma** (early work)
Ishvara Temple	**Arsikere**, Hassan	c. 1220	**16-pointed stellate domed mantapa**; unusual circular hall

Temple	Place	Date / patron	Details
Veeranarayana Temple	**Belavadi**, Chikkamagaluru	c. 1200 (Veera Ballala II)	Trikuta with three different Vishnu forms; 59 bays
Brahmeshwara Temple	**Kikkeri**, Mandya	**1171**	Madanika figures similar to Belur
Mallikarjuna Temple	**Basaralu**, Mandya	**1234** (Narasimha II)	Fine Ravana-lifting-Kailasa panel
Panchalingeshwara Temple	**Govindanahalli**, Mandya	13th c	**Panchakuta**: five shrines in a row
Lakshminarasimha Temple	**Bhadravati**, Shivamogga	Mid-13th c	Trikuta
Harihareshwara Temple	**Harihar**, Davanagere	**1224**, **Polalva Dandanayaka** (Narasimha II)	Harihara (half-Shiva, half-Vishnu) image
Bucheshwara Temple	**Koramangala**, Hassan	1173	Two-shrine temple
Nageshwara–Chennakeshava twin temples	**Mosale**, Hassan	13th c	Identical twin temples
Chennakeshava Temple	**Aralaguppe**, Tumakuru	1250	Fine Hoysala temple
Chennakeshava Temple and **Mule Shankareshwara**	**Turuvekere**, Tumakuru	13th c	Large Ganapati image; Gangadhareshwara
Chennakeshava Temple	**Kaidala**, Tumakuru	Hoysala	Traditionally the birthplace of **Jakanachari**
Lakshmi Narayana Swamy Temple	**Neeragunda**, Arsikere taluk, Hassan	Hoysala	**In the news (Aug 2026):** 12th-century hero stone found during restoration (Section 14)
Hasanamba Temple	Hassan	c. 12th c (Hoysala-era Palegar shrine)	Opens **only once a year** (about 10–15 days in Ashwija/Kartika). **In the news (Oct–Nov 2026).**
Akkana Basadi	Shravanabelagola	**1181**, **Achala Devi (Achiyakka)**, wife of minister Chandramouli of **Veera Ballala II**	Only Hoysala-style basadi at Shravanabelagola
Kirtinarayana	Talakadu	1117	See Section 4
Cheluvanarayana Swamy Temple	**Melukote**, Mandya	Hoysala era; Vijayanagara and Wodeyar additions	**Ramanujacharya** lived here for about 12 years. **Vairamudi Brahmotsava** (diamond crown) festival. **Yoga Narasimha** temple on the hill; unfinished *Raya gopura*; **Academy of Sanskrit Research**
Lakshminarasimha Temple	**Hole Narsipur**, Hassan	Hoysala origins	On the Hemavati
Kalleshwara / **Gangadhareshwara** temples	Various Hassan/Mandya villages	12th–13th c	Many smaller ASI/State monuments

Hoysala exam facts: Soapstone (chloritic schist) allowed fine carving. Sculptors such as **Dasoja** and his son **Chavana** (Belur), **Kedaroja** (Halebidu) and **Ruvari Mallitamma** (Somanathapura, Amruthapura) **signed their work**. Hoysala temples have **no tall gopuras** (gopuras at Belur are Vijayanagara additions).

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9. Vijayanagara Empire (1336–1646 CE)

Political history: Founded in **1336** by **Harihara I and Bukka I** (Sangama dynasty), guided by **Vidyaranya** of Sringeri. The four dynasties were **Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva and Aravidu**. **Devaraya II** brought in Muslim cavalry and archers; **Abdur Razzaq** (Persian envoy) visited in his reign. **Krishnadevaraya** (Tuluva, **1509–1529**) won at **Raichur (1520)** and **Udayagiri (Odisha)**, wrote *Amuktamalyada* (Telugu), and kept the **Ashtadiggajas** poets at court. Foreign visitors included **Nicolo de Conti** (Italian), **Domingo Paes** and **Fernao Nuniz** (Portuguese). The empire was defeated at the **Battle of Talikota (Rakkasa-Tangadi), 1565**, by the combined Deccan Sultanates; Hampi was sacked for about six months. The Aravidu line moved to **Penukonda, Chandragiri and Vellore**. Successor states: the **Mysuru Wodeyars, Keladi Nayakas, Madurai, Tanjore and Gingee Nayakas**.

9A. Hampi Group of Monuments, Vijayanagara district (UNESCO 1986)

On the **Tungabhadra**; linked to **Kishkindha** of the Ramayana (Anegundi, Anjanadri, Pampa Sarovar, Matanga, Malyavanta).

Temple / monument	Date / patron	Details
Virupaksha (Pampapati) Temple	Original shrine 7th c; expanded in the 14th–16th c; **ranga mantapa built by Krishnadevaraya (1510)** for his coronation	**Living temple**. East gopura (**Bistappayya gopura**) about **50 m (≈165 ft)**. **Pinhole-camera** inverted shadow of the gopura. Annual **Phalapuja** (Pampa–Virupaksha marriage) and **chariot festival**
Vittala Temple	Begun under **Devaraya II** (15th c); expanded under **Krishnadevaraya**	**Stone chariot (ratha)** (a Garuda shrine, shown on the **new ₹50 note**). **56 musical "SaReGaMa" pillars** in the *ranga mantapa*; *kalyana mantapa*; finest Vijayanagara art
Hazara Rama Temple	Early 15th c, **Devaraya I**	**Royal chapel** in the royal centre; outer walls carry **Ramayana reliefs** and processions of the **Mahanavami festival**
Krishna Temple	**1513**, **Krishnadevaraya**	Built after the **Udayagiri (Odisha) campaign**; the Balakrishna idol brought from there is now in the Chennai museum; **Krishna Bazaar** in front
Achyutaraya (Tiruvengalanatha) Temple	**1534**, Hiriya Tirumalaraja, officer of **Achyutaraya**	Large double-enclosure temple; **Achyutaraya Bazaar** (courtesan street)
Lakshmi Narasimha (Ugra Narasimha) monolith	**1528**, **Krishnadevaraya**; carved by **Krishnabhatta**	**6.7 m** monolith, the largest in Hampi
Badavilinga	Same period	3 m monolithic linga, always standing in water; built by a poor peasant woman (*badava*)
Kadalekalu Ganesha	15th–16th c	4.5 m monolith shaped like a Bengal gram (*kadale*)
Sasivekalu Ganesha	**1506** inscription	2.4 m monolith shaped like a mustard seed (*sasive*); in memory of **Saluva Narasimha**
Hemakuta hill temples	9th–14th c (pre-Vijayanagara)	Trikuta Jain-style Shaiva shrines
Malyavanta Raghunatha Temple	15th–16th c	On the hill where Rama is said to have waited out the monsoon
Pattabhirama Temple	16th c	Kamalapura
Chandrashekhara, **Saraswati**, **Uddana Veerabhadra**, **Chandikeshwara** temples	15th–16th c	Royal centre temples

Temple / monument	Date / patron	Details
Ganigitti Jain Temple	**1385**, **Irugappa**, general of **Bukka II** (Harihara II)	Shows Vijayanagara's religious tolerance
Anegundi and **Anjanadri Hill**	—	Anegundi was the pre-Vijayanagara capital. **Anjanadri** (Koppal) is believed to be the birthplace of **Hanuman**; a major development project is under way. **Pampa Sarovar**.
Secular monuments	—	**Lotus Mahal (Chitrangi Mahal)**, **Elephant Stables**, **Queen's Bath**, **Mahanavami Dibba** (royal platform for Dasara), **stepped tank (Pushkarani)**, **Talarigatta gate**, aqueducts, **Kamalapura** archaeological museum

9B. Other Vijayanagara-period temples

Temple	Place	Details
Vidyashankara Temple	**Sringeri**, Chikkamagaluru	**1338**, built in memory of **Vidyashankara (Vidyatirtha)** by **Vidyaranya** with **Harihara and Bukka's** patronage. **Hoysala–Vijayanagara blend**; **12 zodiac pillars**: sunlight falls on the pillar of the current zodiac sign
Mylara Lingeshwara Temple	**Mylara**, Vijayanagara district	Annual **Karnika** (one-line prophecy spoken by the *goravappa*) in February
Someshwara Temple	Kolar	14th c, ornate Vijayanagara mantapa
Someshwara Temple	**Ulsoor (Halasuru)**, Bengaluru	Chola origin; large Vijayanagara and Kempegowda additions
Kote Venkataramana Temple	Bengaluru	1689, **Chikkadevaraja Wodeyar**; Dravida with Vijayanagara elements; next to Tipu's palace
Bhoga Nandishwara mantapa	Nandi	Vijayanagara kalyana mantapa (Section 4)
Kurudumale Ganapati	Kolar	13.5 ft Ganapati; Vijayanagara mantapa
Mudabidri Saavira Kambada Basadi	Dakshina Kannada	1430 (Section 11)
Gokarna, **Udupi**, **Kollur**	Coast	Received major Vijayanagara patronage (Section 12)

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10. Keladi Nayakas, Kempegowdas and Mysuru Wodeyars

10A. Keladi (Ikkeri) Nayakas (1499–1763), Shivamogga

Vijayanagara feudatories who became independent after 1565. Capitals: **Keladi → Ikkeri → Bidanur (Nagara)**. **Shivappa Nayaka** introduced the **Shist** revenue system. **Rani Chennamma of Keladi** gave refuge to **Rajaram, son of Shivaji**, against Aurangzeb. The kingdom was annexed by **Hyder Ali (1763)**.

Temple	Place	Details
Aghoreshwara Temple	**Ikkeri**, Sagar taluk	16th c; large granite temple mixing Hoysala, Vijayanagara and Kadamba features; **Parvati shrine** alongside; huge Nandi

Temple	Place	Details
Rameshwara and Veerabhadra Temples	**Keladi**	Kuladevata temples; painted wooden ceilings; Gandaberunda carving; Keladi museum
Kollur Mookambika	Udupi	Major Keladi patronage (Section 12)

10B. Kempegowdas (Yelahanka Nadaprabhus), founders of Bengaluru (1537)

- **Dodda Basavana Gudi (Bull Temple)**, Basavanagudi: **1537**, **Kempegowda I**; 4.5 m monolithic Nandi. **Kadalekai Parishe** (groundnut fair) is held here.
- **Gavi Gangadhareshwara**, Gavipuram: natural cave temple. On **Makara Sankranti** sunlight passes between the horns of the Nandi to fall on the linga.
- **Dodda Ganapathi Temple**, Basavanagudi.
- The four **Kempegowda watchtowers** (Lalbagh, Ulsoor, Mekhri Circle, Kempambudhi).

10C. Chitradurga Nayakas (Palegars)

- **Chitradurga fort** ("Kallina Kote", seven rings): Hidimbeshwara, Ekanatheshwari, Sampige Siddheshwara and Phalguneshwara temples within. **Onake Obavva** fought off Hyder Ali's soldiers with a pestle (*onake*). Last ruler: **Madakari Nayaka**.

10D. Mysuru Wodeyars (1399–1947)

Raja Wodeyar I took Srirangapatna (1610) and began the **Mysuru Dasara**. **Kanthirava Narasaraja** and **Chikkadevaraja** (1673–1704) followed. Power passed to **Hyder Ali and Tipu Sultan** (1761–1799). **Krishnaraja Wodeyar III** was restored in 1799 under Dewan **Purnaiah**. **Krishnaraja Wodeyar IV** (Nalvadi) is known for "Rajarshi" model administration.

Temple	Place	Details
Chamundeshwari Temple	**Chamundi Hills**, Mysuru	Shakti peetha tradition; original shrine c. 12th c. **Seven-tier gopura built by Krishnaraja Wodeyar III (1827)**. **Monolithic Nandi (4.9 m, 1659, Dodda Devaraja Wodeyar)** on the 1,000-step path. **Mahishasura statue** at the summit. **Navaratri/Dasara**: the Dasara is inaugurated at this temple and the goddess's idol rides in the **golden howdah** in the **Jamboo Savari**. **In the news (Dasara 11–21 Oct 2026).**
Srikanteshwara (Nanjundeshwara) Temple	**Nanjangud**, Mysuru	"**Dakshina Kashi**"; Ganga/Chola origins with Hoysala, Vijayanagara and Wodeyar additions; 120 ft gopura (Wodeyar era). **Tipu Sultan** offered an emerald linga and called the deity "**Hakim Nanjunda**" after his elephant was cured. **Dodda Jatre** car festival.
Palace temples	Mysuru Palace	**Shweta Varahaswamy** (Hoysala style, 19th c), **Prasanna Krishnaswamy** (1829), **Trinesvaraswamy**, **Lakshmiramana** (oldest in the fort)
Ranganatha, Srirangapatna; **Cheluvanarayana**, Melukote	Mandya	Major Wodeyar patronage
Biligiri Rangaswamy Temple	**BR Hills**, Chamarajanagar	Hill shrine of Vishnu; tiger reserve (BRT); Soliga tribal links
Male Mahadeshwara Temple	**MM Hills**, Chamarajanagar	15th c saint **Male Mahadeshwara**; huge Mahashivaratri and Deepavali jatras
Himavad Gopalaswamy Temple	Gopalaswamy Betta, Gundlupet	Built by Hoysala ruler Ballala, Wodeyar patronage; mist-covered hill (**"Himavad"**) in Bandipur

11. Jain basadis and monoliths

Karnataka has **all the major Bahubali monoliths**:

Monolith	Place	Height	Date / patron
Gommateshwara	Shravanabelagola, Hassan	**57 ft**	c. 981–983, **Chavundaraya** (Ganga)
Karkala Bahubali	Karkala, Udupi	**42 ft**	**1432**, **Veera Pandya Bhairarasa** (Bhairarasa Wodeyars, Vijayanagara feudatories)
Venur Bahubali	Venur, Dakshina Kannada	**35 ft**	**1604**, **Timmaraja Ajila**
Dharmasthala Bahubali	Ratnagiri hill, Dharmasthala	**39 ft**	**1982**, installed by **Dr D. Veerendra Heggade**
Gommatagiri	Mysuru district	about 20 ft	12th c (traditional)

Basadi	Place	Details
Saavira Kambada Basadi (Tribhuvana Tilaka Chudamani)	**Mudabidri**, Dakshina Kannada	**1430**; "**Thousand-pillar temple**" to Chandranatha; Mudabidri is called the "**Jaina Kashi**" of the south; 18 basadis there; **Dhavala** manuscripts (palm-leaf Jain canon)
Chaturmukha Basadi	**Karkala**	**1586**, Immadi Bhairarasa; four identical faces (*sarvatobhadra*)
Brahma Jinalaya	Lakkundi	1007, Attimabbe
Kamal Basadi	**Belagavi fort**	**1204**, **Ratta** dynasty; ceiling with a lotus of 72 petals
Panchakuta Basadi	Kambadahalli	Ganga, 10th c
Meguti	Aihole	634 CE
Jain Narayana	Pattadakal	Rashtrakuta
Halebidu basadis	Hassan	Hoysala, 1133 onward
Akkana Basadi and **Chavundaraya Basadi**	Shravanabelagola	Hoysala / Ganga
Humcha (Hombuja) Padmavati Basadi	Shivamogga	Seat of the **Santara** dynasty; Padmavati cult
Varanga Kere Basadi	Udupi	Jain temple in the middle of a lake
Shankha Basadi	Lakshmeshwar	Kalyani Chalukya
Ganigitti	Hampi	1385
Bandalike basadis	Shivamogga	Kalyani Chalukya era Jain centre

12. Major pilgrimage temples

12A. Coastal Karnataka (Udupi, Dakshina Kannada, Uttara Kannada)

Temple	Place	Details
Sri Krishna Matha	**Udupi**	Founded **13th c by Madhvacharya** (Dvaita). Devotees see Krishna through the **Kanakana Kindi** (the window where Krishna is said to have turned to give darshan to the low-caste saint **Kanakadasa**). Run in turn by the **Ashta Mathas**; the **Paryaya** handover happens every two years in January (most recent January 2026). Udupi is the home of **Yakshagana** and the **"Udupi cuisine"** tradition.

Temple	Place	Details
Kukke Subramanya	Sullia taluk, Dakshina Kannada	Worship of Subrahmanya as **Naga (serpent)**; *Sarpa samskara*, *Ashlesha bali* rituals. **Richest Muzrai temple in Karnataka** for 15 years running (₹167.89 crore in 2025–26). A development authority was announced in the 2026 State budget.
Dharmasthala Manjunatha	Belthangady, Dakshina Kannada	About 800 years old. A Shiva temple with **Madhva (Vaishnava) priests**, administered by the **Jain Heggade family** (**Dr D. Veerendra Heggade**, nominated to the Rajya Sabha in 2022). **Annadana**, **Laksha Deepotsava** (Kartika), 39 ft Bahubali, Manjusha museum. **In the news** (Section 14).
Kateel Durgaparameshwari	Dakshina Kannada	Temple on an islet in the **Nandini river**; Yakshagana *mela* (troupes)
Kadri Manjunatha	Mangaluru	**968 CE**, Alupa king **Kundavarma**; famous **bronze Lokeshwara** image (among the oldest dated bronzes in south India); Nath tradition; *Pandava caves*
Mangaladevi Temple	Mangaluru	The city takes its name from **Mangaladevi**; Alupa origins
Polali Rajarajeshwari	Bantwal	Giant **clay idol** of the goddess; Alupa era
Sharavu Mahaganapati	Mangaluru	Shaiva–Ganapati shrine
Mahalingeshwara	Puttur	Annual jatre
Kollur Mookambika	Byndoor taluk, Udupi	At the foot of **Kodachadri**. **Adi Shankara** is said to have installed the Sri Chakra; **Keladi** patronage. Second-richest Muzrai temple (₹85 crore). Development authority announced 2026.
Mahabaleshwara Temple	**Gokarna**, Uttara Kannada	Holds the **Atmalinga** (legend of Ravana and Ganesha), "**Dakshina Kashi**". Management dispute: handed to the **Ramachandrapura Math (2008)**, quashed by the HC (2018); the **Supreme Court (2021)** set up an **overseeing committee headed by Justice B.N. Srikrishna**. Om beach; Maha Ganapati temple.
Murudeshwar Temple	Bhatkal taluk, Uttara Kannada	On the Kanduka hill by the Arabian sea. **37 m (123 ft) Shiva statue** (second tallest in the world) and a **20-storey Raja Gopura** (about 76 m); developed by industrialist **R.N. Shetty**; Atmalinga legend
Idagunji Mahaganapati	Honnavar	Standing two-armed Ganesha
Marikamba Temple	**Sirsi**	**1688**; **biennial Marikamba jatre**, one of the largest fairs in Karnataka
Sahasralinga	Sirsi (Shalmala river)	Hundreds of lingas carved on riverbed rocks; Sonda kings

12B. Malnad and central Karnataka

Temple	Place	Details
Sharadamba Temple and **Sringeri Matha**	Sringeri	**First of the four amnaya mathas** set up by **Adi Shankaracharya (8th c)** on the **Tunga**; **Vidyashankara** temple (1338)
Annapoorneshwari	**Horanadu**, Chikkamagaluru	Bhadra river valley; free food (annadana) tradition
Kalaseshwara	**Kalasa**, Chikkamagaluru	Hoysala-era shrine on the Bhadra
Chowdeshwari	**Sigandur**, Sagar taluk	Island temple on the **Sharavati backwaters**; reached by the new **Ambaragodlu–Kalasavalli cable-stayed bridge** (opened 2025)
Bhoothappa / Kote temples	Shivamogga	Folk deities

Temple	Place	Details
Guddattu Vinayaka (cave)	Udupi	Rock-cut cave
Hasanamba	Hassan	Opens once a year (Section 14)
Shivaganga Gangadhareshwara	Shivagange hill, Tumakuru	**“Dakshina Kashi”** tradition; ghee turns into butter legend; Kempegowda era
Siddalingeshwara	**Yediyur**, Tumakuru	Samadhi of Virashaiva saint **Tontada Siddalinga** (15th c)
Devarayanadurga Yoga Narasimha	Tumakuru	Hill temple, Mysuru Wodeyar patronage
Ghati Subramanya	Doddaballapur	Subramanya with Narasimha (single stone)
Kotilingeshwara	**Kammasandra**, Kolar	Modern (1980); **33 m linga**, one of the largest in the world, with lakhs of small lingas

12C. North Karnataka

Temple	Place	Details
Renuka Yellamma Temple	**Saundatti**, Belagavi	Renuka–Jamadagni legend; huge Bharata Hunnime jatre; historical link with the **Devadasi system** (now banned)
Godachi Veerabhadra	Ramdurg, Belagavi	Large annual fair
Ulavi Channabasaveshwara	Joida, Uttara Kannada	Samadhi of **Channabasavanna**, where the Sharanas fled with the vachana bundles after the Kalyana revolution
Banashankari	Badami	Section 5
Kudalasangama	Bagalkot	Basavanna’s aikya
Sharanabasaveshwara	Kalaburagi	19th c; Lingayat saint; great car festival
Dattatreya Temple	**Ganagapura**, Kalaburagi	**Narasimha Saraswati** (Datta tradition); Bhima–Amarja confluence
Narasimha Jharni	Bidar	**Cave temple where pilgrims wade through chest-deep water** to reach the deity
Papnash Shiva Temple	Bidar	Ancient linga with a pond
Chandralamba Parameshwari	**Sannati**, Kalaburagi	Near the Buddhist site of Kanaganahalli
Hulgi Huligemma	Koppal	Large jatre
Mylara	Vijayanagara district	Karnika prophecy

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13. Other monuments: Buddhist, prehistoric, Indo-Islamic, colonial

13A. Prehistoric and Mauryan

- **Hirebenakal** (Koppal): the **largest megalithic necropolis** in south India (about 2,000 burials, dolmens), roughly 800 BCE–200 BCE. Proposed for UNESCO (2026).
- **Maski** (Raichur): **Ashokan minor rock edict** discovered by **C. Beadon (1915)**. It is the **first edict to name “Devanampiya Asoka”** directly. Other Ashokan edicts in Karnataka: **Brahmagiri, Siddapura, Jatinga-Rameshwara** (Chitradurga), **Gavimath, Palkigundu** (Koppal), **Nittur, Udegolam** (Ballari), **Sannati** (Kalaburagi).

- **Brahmagiri** (Chitradurga): excavated by **Mortimer Wheeler (1947)**; Neolithic–megalithic sequence.
- **Sanganakallu** and **Kupgal** (Ballari): Neolithic sites, rock art.

13B. Buddhist

- **Kanaganahalli–Sannati** (Kalaburagi, Bhima river): **Satavahana-era Maha Stupa** with a **relief of Emperor Ashoka labelled "Raya Asoka"**, the only portrait sculpture of Ashoka bearing his name.
- **Namdroling Monastery ("Golden Temple")**, **Bylakuppe**, Kodagu/Mysuru: Tibetan settlement (1960s).

13C. Indo-Islamic (Bahmani, Barid Shahi, Adil Shahi), Deccan Sultanate Tentative List

Monument	Place	Details
Gol Gumbaz	**Vijayapura**	**1656**, tomb of **Muhammad Adil Shah**; architect **Yaqut of Dabul**; among the largest domes in the world; **whispering gallery**
Ibrahim Rauza	Vijayapura	**1626**, **Ibrahim Adil Shah II**; called the "**Taj Mahal of the Deccan**"
Malik-e-Maidan (cannon), **Bara Kaman**, **Jama Masjid**, **Upli Buruj**, **Taj Bawdi**, **Asar Mahal**	Vijayapura	Adil Shahi
Jama Masjid, Gulbarga Fort	**Kalaburagi**	**1367**; **covered mosque with no open courtyard**; architect **Rafi of Qazvin**
Khwaja Bande Nawaz Dargah, **Haft Gumbaz**	Kalaburagi	Bahmani
Mahmud Gawan Madrasa	**Bidar**	**1472**; Persian-style college with glazed tiles
Bidar Fort, **Rangin Mahal** (Bidriware and inlay), **Bahmani tombs at Ashtur**, **Barid Shahi tombs**	Bidar	Capital moved from Gulbarga to Bidar (1429) under **Ahmad Shah Wali**
Daria Daulat Bagh (summer palace, 1784), **Gumbaz** (Hyder and Tipu tombs), **Jama Masjid**, Srirangapatna fort, **Colonel Bailey's dungeon**	**Srirangapatna**	**Tipu Sultan** died here on **4 May 1799** (Fourth Anglo-Mysore War)
Tipu Sultan's Summer Palace	Bengaluru	1791; Indo-Islamic teak structure

13D. Palaces and colonial-era monuments

- **Mysuru Palace (Amba Vilas)**: rebuilt **1897–1912** after a fire; architect **Henry Irwin**; Indo-Saracenic; lit with about 1 lakh bulbs during Dasara.
- **Jaganmohan Palace** (art gallery), **Lalitha Mahal**, **Chamarajendra art gallery**.
- **Bangalore Palace** (1887, Tudor style); **Attara Kacheri / High Court** (1868); **Vidhana Soudha** (**1956**, CM **Kengal Hanumanthaiah**, Neo-Dravidian); **Vikasa Soudha** (2005).
- **St Philomena's Church**, Mysuru (Neo-Gothic, 1936). **Rosario Cathedral**, Mangaluru.

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14. Temples in the news, May–Nov 2026

> Window: roughly **May 2026 to 7 November 2026**, plus a short list of important **earlier-2026** items exams may still ask about. Items marked ⚠️ come from a single or secondary source and should be confirmed in the original newspaper before relying on them.

14A. May–November 2026

#	Month (2026)	Temple / site	What happened	Source(s)
1	**29 Oct–11 Nov**	**Hasanamba Temple, Hassan**	Annual **Hasanamba Jatra Mahotsava**. The Hoysala-era shrine opens only once a year; public darshan from about 30 Oct to 10 Nov. In 2025 over 20 lakh devotees visited.	Deccan Herald; Incredible India
2	**Late Oct**	**Gali Anjaneya Swamy Temple, Bengaluru**	**Karnataka High Court set aside the State government's takeover** (under the Muzrai/HRCE law) of the temple and ordered management handed back within a week. The takeover had followed allegations about temple funds and property.	Organiser, 28 Oct 2026
3	**26 Oct**	**Dharmasthala**	Newslaundry explainer on the **SIT probe** into the 2025 "mass burial" allegations, after the complainant was arrested for perjury (Aug 2025) and the SIT report was filed in the Belthangady court.	Newslaundry; Deccan Chronicle
4	**24–29 Oct** ⚠️	**Hampi**	A **UNESCO monitoring mission** was reported to review conservation and the master plan for Hampi, Anegundi and Anjanadri.	ad-hoc-news (single source)
5	**15 Oct** ⚠️	**Hampi**	Headline: **HAL commits ₹23.60 crore (CSR)** to restore Hampi, the Taj Mahal and Bekal Fort.	Indian Masterminds
6	**11–21 Oct**	**Chamundeshwari Temple, Mysuru**	**Mysuru Dasara 2026**: inauguration at the temple on Chamundi Hills (11 Oct); **Jamboo Savari** with the goddess in the golden howdah on **Vijayadashami (21 Oct)**.	Outlook; Adda247; Usthadian
7	**19 Sept**	**TTD Venkateshwara temple, Surathkal (Mangaluru)**	**State Cabinet approved 10 acres** at Surathkal for a **Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams** temple.	Deccan Herald
8	**Aug**	**Lakshmi Narayana Swamy Temple, Neeragunda (Arsikere taluk, Hassan)**	During restoration, a **12th-century Hoysala veeragallu (hero stone)** in Old Kannada was found. It commemorates soldier **Boppa** (inscription by his wife **Maravve**), who died soon after **King Vishnuvardhana's death at Bankapura**. Dated **11 December 1141**, it could settle the long debate over the year of Vishnuvardhana's death (earlier estimates 1141 to 1152).	The Hindu (via GKToday, Insights IAS, Star of Mysore)
9	**22 July**	**Temple lands (statewide)**	Editorial: **over 1,000 acres of temple land** in Karnataka encroached; calls for accountability.	Deccan Herald editorial
10	**16 July**	**Muzrai temples (statewide)**	Government said **temple donations will be used only for temple development**; **CCTV cameras over donation boxes** in about 39,000 Muzrai temples; flagged Muzrai properties outside the state (7 acres at Tirupati).	NewKerala/IANS ; Webindia123
11	**July**	**Ranganatha Swamy, Srirangapatna**	An **18th-century inscription of Immadi Krishnaraja Wodeyar** found at **Dibbur (Hesaraghatta hobli)** records a **village grant to the Srirangapatna Ranganatha temple**.	Organiser
12	**June**	**Hoysala Lakshmi Narasimhaswamy temple, Hassan district**	Feature on **unfinished ASI restoration**: kitchen, mantapas, lighting and compound wall still incomplete; ASI cited technical issues.	Deccan Herald
13	**June**	**Talakal, Koppal (Mailaralingeshwara tradition)**	**740-year-old (13th c) inscription** found, recording royal grants to scholars, musicians and artists.	Organiser, 2 Jun 2026

#	Month (2026)	Temple / site	What happened	Source(s)
14	**June**	**Vijayanagara-era hero temple**	A rare **hero temple with hunting-scene hero stones** was identified in a Karnataka village (Pulasani Oddu).	Asianet Newsable; Inshorts
15	**21 June**	**Hampi**	Hampi was **among 12 heritage sites chosen for International Yoga Day 2026** events.	Udayavani
16	**31 May**	**Dharmasthala Manjunatha**	**Vice President C.P. Radhakrishnan** visited and offered prayers.	Vice President's Secretariat
17	**30 May**	**Hampi**	**ASI excavation** found a **Vijayanagara-era drainage system** and the **roof remains of a rare Jain temple**.	Organiser, 30 May 2026
18	**May**	**Hampi**	**Ancient Alvar (Vaishnava saint) idols** unearthed during excavation.	Inshorts
19	**17 May**	**Lakkundi (Kote Veerabhadreshwara temple), Gadag**	The excavation started in January has yielded **over 3,000 artefacts**; a search for the legendary "**100 temples and 100 wells**" continues; officials are preparing a **UNESCO bid**.	Asianet Newsable; ThePrint/Telangana Today (gold ornaments find)
20	**May**	**Kukke Subramanya and Kollur Mookambika**	Kukke Subramanya was the **richest temple in Karnataka for the 15th year running (₹167.89 crore, 2025–26)**; Kollur Mookambika collected **₹85 crore**, a record.	TV9 Kannada
21	**May**	**Kampli, Ballari/Vijayanagara**	A previously unpublished **16th-century Vijayanagara inscription** was found near the Narihalla stream.	Asianet Newsable
22	**May**	**Gowripura temple, Davanagere**	**15th-century copper plates** kept at the temple trace the **Sangama dynasty lineage to Devaraya II**.	Deccan Chronicle
23	Ongoing	**Anubhava Mantapa, Basavakalyan**	The ₹600+ crore memorial was promised for inauguration in **2026** (CM's May 2025 statement); completion not yet confirmed.	Deccan Herald
24	Upcoming	**Dharmasthala Laksha Deepotsava**; **Hampi Utsav**	**Karthika Masa** runs from about 10 Nov to 8 Dec 2026 (Laksha Deepotsava at Dharmasthala). The CM announced (Feb 2026) that **Hampi Utsav will be held every year on 3–5 November**.	HinduTone; Hans India; Deccan Chronicle

14B. Earlier in 2026 (Jan–Apr): still exam-relevant

Month	Site	News	Source
10 Apr	**Shravanabelagola, Lakkundi, Hirebenakal**	State proposed these three for **UNESCO World Heritage** nomination	Deccan Herald
Apr	**Belur–Halebidu–Somanathapura**	Feature on **tourist pressure and selfie crowds** at the UNESCO Hoysala temples	ThePrint
Apr	**Basavanna temple, Kalluru (Shivamogga)**	**Vijayanagara Nandigamba (pillar) inscription of 1424** recording a land grant to the **Virupaksha temple**	Asianet Newsable
Mar (Budget)	**Kukke Subramanya and Kollur Mookambika**	**Development authorities** announced for both temples	TV9 Kannada
14 Feb	**Hampi**	Hampi Utsav 2026 held; annual November schedule announced	Deccan Chronicle
Feb	**All A/B-category Muzrai temples**	**Prior permission and a fee now mandatory for filming / reels** in temples	Asianet Newsable

Month	Site	News	Source
16 Jan onward	**Lakkundi**	**Excavation at Kote Veerabhadreshwara temple** began: seven-hooded Naga stone, Neolithic relics, a 10th-c Eshwara shrine inside a house, an inscription near the Chandramouleshwara temple	Deccan Herald; Organiser; Drishti IAS
Jan	**Mahalakshmi Temple, K. Bettahalli (Pandavapura, Mandya)**	**12th-century multilingual inscription** showing a **Hoysala–Tamil** connection	Deccan Herald
15 Jan	**Muzrai temples**	Order to distribute **Sankranti prasada** (sesame, jaggery, coconut) in all Muzrai temples	Asianet Newsable
Jan	**Udupi**	Biennial **Paryaya** handover among the Ashta Mathas	—

15. One-line quick-revision facts

- **Oldest Kannada inscription:** Halmidi (c. 450 CE, Kadamba).
- **Oldest dated structural temple in Karnataka:** Meguti, Aihole (634 CE).
- **“Cradle of Indian temple architecture”:** Aihole.
- **Coronation site of the Chalukyas:** Pattadakal.
- **Apsidal (elephant-back) temple:** Durga temple, Aihole.
- **18-armed Nataraja:** Badami Cave 1. **Largest cave, inscription of 578 CE:** Cave 3 (Mangalesha).
- **Virupaksha, Pattadakal:** Lokamahadevi, after Vikramaditya II’s win over the Pallavas; model for Ellora’s Kailasa.
- **“Devalaya Chakravarti”:** Mahadeva temple, Itagi (1112).
- **Attimabbe “Danachintamani”:** Brahma Jinalaya, Lakkundi (1007).
- **Belur (1117):** Vishnuvardhana, after the Talakad victory over the Cholas. **Halebidu (1121):** Ketamalla. **Somanathapura (1268):** Somanatha Dandanayaka.
- **Earliest Hoysala temple:** Lakshmidevi, Doddagaddavalli (1113).
- **Hoysala UNESCO listing:** Sept 2023, India’s **42nd** WHS.
- **Stone chariot on the ₹50 note:** Vittala temple, Hampi.
- **Musical pillars:** Vittala temple, Hampi.
- **Battle of Talikota / Rakkasa-Tangadi:** 1565.
- **Vidyashankara, Sringeri (1338):** 12 zodiac pillars.
- **Gommateshwara:** 57 ft, Chavundaraya, c. 981–983; next Mahamastakabhisheka in 2030.
- **Thousand-pillar basadi:** Mudabidri (1430).
- **Gavi Gangadhareshwara:** sunlight on the linga at Makara Sankranti.
- **First mention of “Bengaluru”:** Begur inscription (c. 890 CE).
- **Kanakana Kindi:** Udupi Krishna Matha.
- **Atmalinga:** Gokarna (and the Murudeshwar legend).
- **Richest Muzrai temple:** Kukke Subramanya (₹167.89 crore, 2025–26).
- **Temple open once a year:** Hasanamba, Hassan.
- **Chamundeshwari gopura:** Krishnaraja Wodeyar III (1827); **Nandi** on Chamundi Hills: 1659.
- **“Hakim Nanjunda”:** Tipu Sultan’s name for Nanjundeshwara, Nanjangud.
- **Ashoka portrait labelled “Raya Asoka”:** Kanaganahalli (Sannati).
- **Maski edict:** first to name “Asoka” (found 1915).
- **Gol Gumbaz:** 1656, Muhammad Adil Shah; whispering gallery.
- **Jama Masjid, Gulbarga:** 1367, no courtyard.
- **2026 news hooks:** Neeragunda hero stone (Vishnuvardhana’s death, 11 Dec 1141); Lakkundi excavation (3,000+ artefacts); Shravanabelagola, Lakkundi and Hirebenakal UNESCO proposal; HC quashing the takeover of Gali Anjaneya temple; Hasanamba jatra; Dasara 11–21 Oct; TTD temple land at Surathkal; Hampi excavation (drainage system, Jain temple roof, Alvar idols).

Prepared for KPSC/KEA exam preparation. Historical dates follow standard ASI, Karnataka Gazetteer and textbook sources; where scholars disagree, the commonly accepted exam date is given with “c.”. News items link to the original reports; verify ⚠️ items before quoting them in an exam answer.